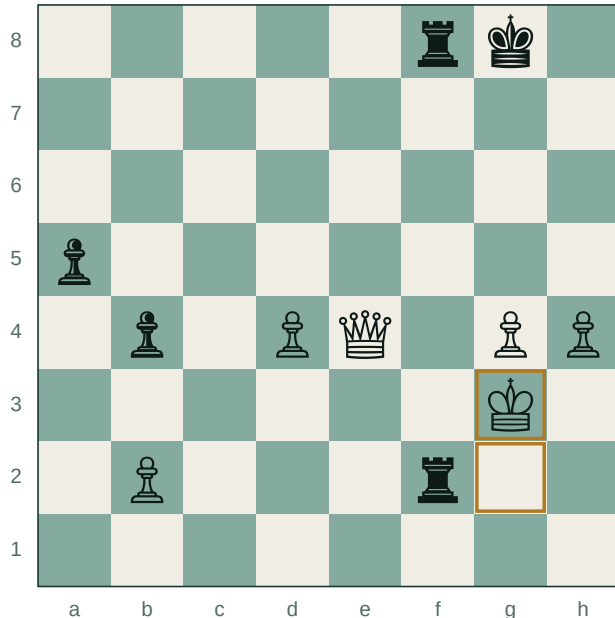


Queen-and-rook endings: Black, move 43

Queen-and-rook endings

Black to move



Previous move: 43.Kg3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

43...R8f3+ 44. Qxf3 Rxf3+ 45. Kxf3 a4 46. Ke4 a3 47. bxa3 bxa3

43...R8f3+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **44.Qxf3**.

44...Rxf3+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the queen on f3. Recorded reply: **45.Kxf3**.

45...a4 The pawn moves from a5 to a4. Recorded reply: **46.Ke4**.

46...a3 The pawn moves from a4 to a3. Recorded reply: **47.bxa3**.

47...bxa3 The pawn captures the pawn on a3.

At the end, nominal material is White 3 / Black 1 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by -1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -1: the balance goes from -1 to -2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on g3. Geometrically undefended: queen on e4. Check for tactical protection.